



Queensland Mines Rescue Service

Technical Advisory Committee (TAC) Meeting Minutes – Meeting No. 81

Action	Route	Initials
1.		
2.		
3.	File	

Date	7 May 2025	Venue	Boardroom - Western Gateway Motel Emerald (Hospital Road)
Time	12.00pm	Chair	Kerri Melkersson, Executive Director, Simtars, RSHQ
Committee Members	Kerri Melkersson – Simtars – Chair (KM) Peter Purdie, Anglo American – Team member representative (PP) (Online) Wouter Niehaus, Anglo American - Coal operator/owner member (WN) Ron Wilkinson, RSHQ – Inspectorate member (RW) Craig Smith - MEU (CS) Clinton Battese, QMRS – QMRS Operations Manager – Secretariat (CB)		
Secretariat	Clinton Battese, QMRS – QMRS Operations Manager – Secretariat (CB)		
Invited Guest/s	Tim Jackson, CEO QMRS (TJ)		
Apologies			
Attachments	Attachment 1 – Mine Recovery Robot ACARP submission Attachment 2 – TAC annual report draft		

Agenda Item	Endorsement Discussion Noting	Recommendation/Action	Responsible Officer	Due Date
1. Welcome and Apologies Chair	Noting	- KM proxy Gareth Kennedy has left Simtars. New proxy is Sean Muller. - Committee members acknowledged and accepted proxy.	KM	
2. Acceptance of Minutes Chair	Endorsement	Acceptance of previous minutes as distributed – minutes accepted	All	
3. Correspondence CB	Noting Discussion	Nil correspondence received	CB	
4. Review outstanding actions Chair	Discussion	- Outstanding actions reviewed 202508-1, 202508-2, 202508-3, 202508-4 and 202508-5 closed	KM	
5. Robot working group update	Discussion	- ACARP submission – Attachment 1 - Group discussed submission.	KM	



Chair 		• KM highlighted that the ACARP submission is for Stage 1 only, which will take approximately 9 months and will conclude in approximately September 2026. This will not be an intrinsically safe product, but will be used to test capability of the robot in mine conditions – heat, smoke, water etc. • KM stated that the purpose of the robot is for improved and more timely data acquisition (utilizing gas sensors, lidar scanner etc) in emergency or post-event situations. TJ also mentioned other uses for operators, including mapping and inspections. • PP sought confirmation that QMRS would not own the robot at the end of the ACARP project. TJ confirmed that this is the case, and that the purpose of the project is to prove the concept and achieve IS certification. ADR likely to then turn this into a commercial product. • KM stated that once the concept is proven, QMRS would be seeking industry support and funding to acquire a unit/s		
6. QMIHSC Emergency Response workshop overview Chair	Discussion	• 2-hour workshop being run by QMRS entitled “<i>Emergency Management and Preparedness</i>” on Sunday session 17 August 2025 for QMIHSC. Six CPD points allocated. • TAC members are asked to volunteer, if able, to support with battle board activity at end of workshop. KM, RW, CS, WN and TJ will be in attendance. PP is unable to be released for the period due to being on shift.	KM	
7. TAC Annual Report Draft Chair 	Discussion	• Attachment 2 • Annual report content discussed. TJ recommended that a line be included seeking guidance from QMRS Board. • TAC members are to review annual report and respond to KM with any other suggested amendments to report by 30/06/25 (Action item 20250507-1) • TJ to discuss invitation for KM at QMRS Planning Session – 23 – 24 June 2025 and confirm (Action item 20250507-2) Action Item 20250507-1 – TAC members to provide suggested edits to draft annual report Action Item 20250507-2 - TJ to confirm if TAC Chair may attend QMRS Board planning session	KM All TJ	30/06/2025 30/05/2025
8. TAC Budget Chair	Discussion	• TJ advised that he will be confirming TAC budget with QMRS Board 08/05/2025	KM	



		- FY25 budget was \$70k, the highest the budget has been. Approximately \$5900 has been expended, noting that RSHQ sponsored the Emergency Response Workshop in October 2024, at a value of \$12k. - TJ advised that request for attendance at IMRB Austria and Western Australian Mines Rescue Competition has not been approved by Board - TJ advised that it is likely there will be a combined budget between TAC and Board of Directors - TJ will come back to KM with confirmation of budget (Action item 20250507-3)		
		Action item 20250507-3 – Confirmation of TAC budget	TJ	01/07/2025
9. TAC focus areas FY26 Chair	Discussion	- Committee to consider recommended focus areas for next financial year - RW recommended research into refuge chambers, after TJ expressed concerns regarding size of mines and self-escape and rescue capability limitations to 1500 metres. - The large amount of CABA needed and the challenges that this poses was discussed. RW shared information about hybrid system of using CABA and self-rescuers in self-escape at a mine he previously worked at – PP highlighted the dangers of changing breathing apparatus more than once. - WN suggested that research not be limited to refuge chambers, but rather global leading practice in self-escape (winders, transport systems etc) – this should be research on existing literature - KM advised, if attending QMRS Board Planning Day, she would also be seeking guidance on Board focus areas and will update committee accordingly	ALL	
10. Operational updates Tim Jackson	Discussion	- Guduza Radio - Still awaiting certification – South African certifying body is unable to discuss with QMRS as they are not the manufacturer - ACARP Exclusion Zones - Stage 2 of project is looking at exclusion zone for shafts, with a meeting with ACARP monitors set for next month - KM asked about progress on calculations associated with some historic mining disasters. TJ advised that there is a second report that has been completed that he will share with TAC members (Action item 20250507-4)		
		Action item 20250507-4 – Share second ACARP report on exclusion zones that includes calculations for historic mining disasters	TJ	30/05/2025



		• Status of Moranbah Rescue Station ○ Development application is in with owner, consent processed ○ Fire break has been completed ○ Offer has been made by Resources Centre of Excellence to connect to their infrastructure – cost unknown at this stage ○ Budget allocated was \$13.5M- likely cost will be \$28M ○ TJ and QMRS Board Chair have met with Minister for Resources regarding funding. Have been advised that budgets have already been set and to approach again in Jan/Feb, and consider approach to Federal Minister before Dec.		
		• Re-commissioning of substations ○ Carborough Downs substation has been returned – North Goonyella, Ironbark, Grosvenor, are ready to go back. Was waiting on an updated declaration of conformity which is now received. Kestrel, Ensham and Crinum are ready to go back once documents are sent out ○ Truck at each station – there will be enough equipment for four teams plus the substation equipment totaling six teams. ○ PP and CB discussed specific requirements of Moranbah North		
		• Steam-Ex fire ○ Finalizing transfer details between Simtars and QMRS ○ Legal document to be signed		
Other business (if required)	Endorsement Discussion Noting	Item	Responsible Officer	Due Date
11. Other Business Chair	Noting Discussion	• PP advised that historically TAC meeting minutes were published on QMRS website for transparency • TJ advised that this could occur, but only after minutes have been sighted by QMRS Board • TJ will take on action to publish TAC minutes post QMRS Board meetings (Action item 202507-5) Action item 20250507-5 – Publish TAC meeting minutes post QMRS Board Meeting	TJ	30/06/2025
12. Meeting Reflections - Were papers distributed to you as per commitment? - Was there sufficient time allocated to	Discussion	All agreed on the following ratings for reflections: Please note that the reflection below was not discussed in TAC meeting in error. Ratings have been applied by Chair, based on date of distribution of agenda, early finish of meeting and no evidence of outstanding decisions based on agenda items.		



discuss agenda items? c. Were all necessary decisions made as per agenda? <i>Rating: 1 being the lowest, 5 being the highest</i>		a. 5 b. 5 c. 5		
--	--	----------------------	--	--

Noting Papers	Nil
----------------------	-----

Meeting Closed:	1.18pm
Next Meeting:	6 August 2025



Outstanding Actions					
Action No	Topic/Issue	Action	Responsible Officer	Due Date	Update/Comments
20241029-3	TAC email address on website	TAC Email address to be placed on QMRS website	CB	15/11/2024 06/08/2025	TJ will take over action and look to adding email address to website and including in newsletter
20250218-1	QMIHSC Level 1 speaker	Confirm that Inspector Peter Currie can be available to speak at QMIHSC Sunday Session on Level 1 lessons	RW	18/03/2025	P Currie unavailable. Workshop has been rescoped so no longer required. Close
20250218-2	First aid live demo – QMIHSC	Confirm with QMIHSC committee that QMRS can provide a live first aid demo in marquee	KM	18/03/2025	QMIHSC have confirmed that live demo is supported. Further details to come once program released. Close
20250218-3	Ideas for QMIHSC Workshop	TAC members to provide topics and speaker suggestions for QMIHSC workshop to KM	All	18/03/2025	See agenda item 6 Close
20250218-4	Robot working group specifications document share with Regulator	Specification document to be shared with Inspectors Greg Napper and Paul Sullivan for comment - feedback to be sent to KM	RW	02/03/2025	Document has been shared and comments received back from Regulator. No material changes Close
20250218-5	Vigilife contacts	Provide KM with contacts from QMRS Board for potential wearable sensor trial	TJ	18/03/2025	TJ liaising directly with Vigilife. Close
New Actions					
Action No	Topic/Issue	Action	Responsible Officer	Due Date	Update/Comments
20250507-1	TAC Annual report	TAC members to provide suggested edits to draft annual report	All	30/06/2025	
20250507-2	QMRS Planning Session Guest	Confirm if TAC Chair may attend QMRS Board planning session 23 – 24 June 2025	TJ	30/05/2025	
20250507-3	TAC budget	Confirmation of TAC budget	TJ	01/07/2025	
20250507-4	Exclusion Zone – Second ACARP report	Share second ACARP report on exclusion zones that includes calculations for historic mining disasters	TJ	30/05/2025	
20250507-5	Publish TAC meeting minutes	Publish TAC meeting minutes post QMRS Board Meeting	TJ	30/06/2025	

